

living in the “lower-level suite,” otherwise known as the basement. I suppose my dad had complained to him of my woeful existence because when he saw me, he had the sympathy in his eyes usually reserved for the bereaved at a funeral.

He said, “Harv, I started in the same way as you, a complete disaster.” Great, I thought, this was making me feel a lot better. I should let him know that I was busy... watching the paint peel off the wall.

He kept going: “But then I got some advice that changed my life, and I’d like to pass it on to you.” Oh, no, here comes the father-son lecture, and he’s not even my father!